

THE WHITE HOUSE

Office of the Press Secretary
(Reykjavik, Iceland)

F306

R

PRESS BRIEFING

BY
GARY SPEAKES

October 12, 1986

White House Press Filing Center
Lottleidir Hotel
Reykjavik, Iceland

11:03 A.M. (L)

INDEX

SUBJECT

PAGE

ANNOUNCEMENTS

President's Schedule.....1
Averts.....1
Sunday Schedule.....1-2, 6
Monday/Washington Schedule.....2, 6, 8, 10
Shultz Briefing.....2, 4-5

FOREIGN

Reagan-Gorbachev Meeting.....1, 4-5, 7, 9, 11
Working Groups.....3-8, 10
Reagan-Gorbachev/Joint Statement.....3
Possible Summit Date.....7
Human Rights/Humanitarianism.....8
Shultz/Brussels.....9
Arbitry.....10
Rovny-Adelman/Asian Nations.....10
Green Peace/ Reykjavik Harbor.....11
Paniloff/Rapinage.....11

DOMESTIC

Congress/SDI/"Buy American".....2

DEPARTMENT OF STATE A/CDC/MR

REVIEWED by

Date

- () RELEASE () DECLASSIFY
() EXISE () DECLASSIFY in PART
() DENY () DELETE
() Non-responsive info.

FOI, EO or PA exemptions

- () CLASSIFY as _____ TS authority for _____
() DOWNGRADE () or () C/OADR

11:24 P.M. (L)
01021-10/12

03 15 00 00 00

THE WHITE HOUSE

Office of the Press Secretary
Reykjavik, Iceland

PRESS BRIEFING
BY
JIMMY SPEAKES

October 12, 1986

White House Press Briefing Center
Lottelids Hotel
Reykjavik, Iceland

11:03 A.M. (L)

MR. SPEAKES: Let me have your attention, please. I begin by -- in an absence of news with some awards. Today the first award goes to -- the Miles Latham Award for Enterprising Reporting goes to Miles Latham. And the headline is: Big Flush With Success After Iceland Toilet Crisis Comes to A Head. (Laughter.) Classic. Which Bathroom -- the discussion was over which bathrooms will be used by President Reagan and Mikhail Gorbachev. I think it was a draw the way it ended.

The second award is The Washington Post-New York Times Consistency in Foreign Policy Award that goes to Reuters today. And Reuters moved a lead that said: "President Reagan appeared stiff and impassive." And then, moments later, they said: "Reagan, looking relaxed and smiling ..." true story. (Laughter.)

Q It's like the weather -- it changes every few minutes. (Laughter.)

MR. SPEAKES: Happens in Iceland, huh?

Q You didn't get a laugh from Gibbons.

MR. SPEAKES: That wasn't Gibbons' story.

Q -- bathroom?

MR. SPEAKES: Gibbons is absolved. Where is he? That was not his story. No -- there are two other colleagues as it falls on them.

The President this morning was up as usual, shortly after 7:00 a.m., read his intelligence briefing, met with Poindexter, Shultz, and Regan in the dining room of the residence at 9:15 a.m. to 9:45 a.m., went to the Hotel House, and at 10:02 a.m. began his meeting with General Secretary Gorbachev. And the two of them are meeting with their Foreign Ministers at this point.

The meeting is scheduled to end around noon and the farewells of the leaders will be covered by a pool. The two are scheduled to walk out on the steps and then the President will escort the General Secretary to his car and the Soviet delegation will leave first, followed by the President.

The President's schedule is that he will then go to the U.S. Ambassador's residence, have lunch with a group, including Secretary Shultz and the others who have been involved in discussions. And he will leave for the airport after meeting the Marine contingent at the embassy -- he will leave at 1:45 p.m.

I will run over the logistics since they're a little bit

plex. The Sunday motorcade pool will be transported back here --

Q -- The Marines? Is this -- are they at the

MR. SPEAKER: Yes. The Marine Guards that work at the

The Sunday motorcade pool will be transported back here around 1:30 p.m. and those of you who wish to cover the President's remarks at Keflavik Airport -- press buses will depart at 1:30 p.m. So, once again, you cannot cover the President's speech at Keflavik and Secretary Shultz's briefing. And once you're at Keflavik Airport, you're there. Also, those electing to cover the remarks at Keflavik will be able to cover -- will not be able to cover Air Force One. So, as I said last night, you have to either cover Shultz or cover one of the events at Keflavik.

We will have an as delivered text of the President's remarks on departure here in this filing center and not at the airport. And we will not have an advance text, because the remarks will be based on what's going on in the meetings.

The fiscal motorcade pool will assemble in the filing center at 1:35 p.m. and be transported to the U.S. Ambassador's residence. The President, as I say, departs at 2:45 p.m., arrives at the airport at 3:30 p.m., makes his remarks at -- what is it? 3:30 p.m.? 3:30 p.m.; Okay. Makes his remarks at 3:30 p.m. in Hangar 635. Air Force One is airborne at 3:45 p.m., arrives at Andrews at 5:50 p.m. The President is at the White House at 6:05 p.m. He will be greeted by the First Lady and the Vice President. I do not know of any elaborate plans for South Grounds greeting, although one could get as more elaborate than the one that is planned.

After your filing time, the press buses for Keflavik Airport will depart the hotel at 4:45 p.m., arrive at 5:30 p.m. The charter leaves at 5:45 p.m. and gets in at 7:05 p.m.

Tomorrow -- will be essentially a holiday schedule at the White House. The press office will certainly operate on holiday hours. We'll have a phone duty person operating during the day and our staff will come in at 5:00 p.m. and remain through the President's speech. The speech is scheduled, as you know, at 3:00 p.m. and we will try to have an advance text available in the press office at 6:00 p.m.

Q Is there going to be any briefing before the speech?

MR. SPEAKER: No briefing planned before the speech.

Q Larry?

Q Where is the speech?

Q Where is the speech? Oval?

MR. SPEAKER: Oval Office.

The -- Secretary Shultz -- the briefing schedule for the remainder of the day: Secretary Shultz will be here at 1:30 p.m. if things are going on time. It will be on-the-record, available for radio and television coverage and will last about 20 minutes.

In addition, a number of U.S. officials are appearing on television shows. "Face the Nation" has Sen. Reagan; "Meet the Press" has Secretary Shultz; "This Week with Brinkley" has Sen. Kampelman; and "CNN Newsmaker" has Sen. Ridgway.

Also, accompanying you here aboard the press plane will be three individuals who were closely involved -- or directly

involved in last night's discussions. They are Bob Linhard, Ken
Adelman, and Peter Rodin. All of them will be available to you on
the press plane. If you please respect the fact that these
fellows will be most of the evening.

And, speaking of that, the group on regional, bilateral
and humanitarian issues met from 3:57 p.m. until 4:30 a.m. this
morning. The arms control group met from 3:57 p.m. until 6:30 a.m.
To be sure we have everything for the record, additional experts were
involved at various times in the meeting as they were called in.

That's all I have. Questions?

Charles.

Q Joint statement?

MR. SPEAKER: Joint statement. There has been no
discussion of it and unless the two leaders decide, either a written
version or a joint appearance within the next hour, I don't
anticipate it. But we do not know whether there'll be anything
written or whether there'll be anything joint.

Q All you expect --

MR. SPEAKER: My best judgment would be that the most you
would see would be a short written statement but I have no guarantee
either way and I'm just trying to guide you.

Robert?

Q -- passed out, you mean a written statement?

MR. SPEAKER: If there were one, it would be passed out.

Q What --

Q Could you tell us how the President was informed of
the work -- the overnight work?

MR. SPEAKER: Yes. The President, in the morning from
9:15 a.m. to 9:45 a.m., was brought up to date by Secretary Shultz,
Feindegger and Regan on the overnight work.

Andrea?

Q Have drafts of statements been worked on by the
working groups?

MR. SPEAKER: No. No draft of the public statements has
been worked on.

Q What is the focus of today's meeting?

MR. SPEAKER: Pardon? What is the what?

Q I didn't hear the question.

MR. SPEAKER: I didn't either.

Q The focus?

MR. SPEAKER: What is the focus of today's meeting? I
think that today's meeting you'd accurately describe it as a review
of last night's working group and further discussion of what they
arrived at last night.

Q Did they arrive at any conclusions?

MR. SPEAKER: I just don't want to comment on it.

MORE

11001-10/11

Jim?

Q... If the session this morning from 9:15 a.m. to 9:45 a.m., did the President have to make any decisions on what was worked on last night? Or was it mostly to report on his articles how far they had gotten on things?

MR. SPEAKES: I think the President had to make decisions about how he wants to conduct today's meetings and that's what he did in consultation with the Secretary and the others.

Q Any specific decisions on particular negotiating matters?

MR. SPEAKES: I would assume, yes.

Let?

Q Is it planned that Secretary Shultz will announce -- are you going to come back and tell us a little bit about what's going to happen at 1:30 p.m.?

MR. SPEAKES: No. OK -- what's going to happen when?

Q Whenever Secretary Shultz gets through?

Q Question?

MR. SPEAKES: No. I think the first word will come -- what's going to happen at the conclusion of the meetings? Now will we know what's going to happen? I think your first word will be Secretary Shultz. Of course, the rumor mill will precede it and then Secretary Shultz will have it.

Q When do you expect him to be here?

MR. SPEAKES: 1:30 p.m.

Now, if there was -- I think if there was some development where the two leaders would be somewhere, we would certainly get it back to you here in the briefing room, we wouldn't wait until then. But, as I see it now, you will see Secretary Shultz and he will tell you about it.

Nike?

Q Are you coordinating anything with the Soviets on simultaneous reports -- Shultz and the Soviets?

MR. SPEAKES: No. They could go first. So --

Q They could go first?

MR. SPEAKES: I said they could get out ahead of us, but so be it.

Q Who's in the meeting this morning?

MR. SPEAKES: The foreign ministers.

Q Just the foreign ministers?

MR. SPEAKES: Yes.

Don?

Q Has there yet been any discussion on a summit with Larry?

MR. SPEAKES: Any discussion on a summit date? I just don't want to be in the middle of it. I honestly don't know what's transpired on that.

Shall we?

Q: What's the significance of the President not seeing Gorbachev this morning and, for that matter, Gorbachev not greeting him yesterday publicly?

MR. SPEAKES: That's the way it was always planned.

Q: What's the question?

MR. SPEAKES: The significance of the President not coming out this morning and the significance of Gorbachev not coming out this afternoon -- yesterday afternoon, versus the significance of the President and Gorbachev bumping into each other at the door at the first meeting? No significance. It's the way it was always planned. The latter two greetings were to take place inside and they did. And they were warm.

Q: Why didn't the meetings go on so long?

MR. SPEAKES: Last night? That's the way they do.

Q: I know -- I mean -- it sounds like they either arrived at something or not.

MR. SPEAKES: It does. (Laughter.) They either arrived at something or they didn't, right?

Q: But I wish, surely they -- they probably were told to stay there until they got something, were they?

MR. SPEAKES: I don't know.

Colonel?

Q: I yield my question to The New York Times.

MR. SPEAKES: Okay. Now about that? This is the real spirit of cooperation.

Q: Any plans for the working groups to meet again this morning or this afternoon?

MR. SPEAKES: No.

Q: Question?

MR. SPEAKES: Are there plans for the working groups to meet this morning or this afternoon? There are none. We did take with us to the meeting this morning our top working groups, so there was an additional group of Linhard, Adelman, Frie, Wisse, Rovny that joined at the White House this morning.

Go to here. Who was it? Right here. Jim.

Q: You said yesterday that the President's remarks will be piped in here, right? Is there any way that Gorbachev's press conference can be piped in here? (Laughter.)

MR. SPEAKES: We'd work it out but we wouldn't get it done. (Laughter.)

Q: It can't be done?

MR. SPEAKES: Pardon?

MR. SPEAKES: It's entirely possible that it could be done, but highly unlikely.

Q: Why not?

MR. SPEAKES: We'll be busy getting the President's remarks --

Q: Do you actually know what's happening and what's going on? You said that the Russians could get out faster than us. I mean, do you know what's actually going to be announced?

MR. SPEAKES: No, no one does.

Q: Why?

Q: Are you going to make available transcripts of the Regan and Shultz appearances on the interview shows?

MR. SPEAKES: Yes. We will make the television appearances available, provided time permits, and I guess it will.

Q: When?

Q: Did the President ask Tip O'Neill if he could address Congress or did he decide from the outset he wanted to make an Oval Office appearance?

MR. SPEAKES: He decided he wanted to make an Oval Office -- within the last 24 hours he reached this decision.

Q: So, there was no conversation with the Hill?

MR. SPEAKES: No? We didn't ask and weren't turned down.

Q: Why?

Q: But isn't, in fact, Congress out of session until Tuesday?

MR. SPEAKES: They are.

Q: So they couldn't have had it anyway.

MR. SPEAKES: Possible.

Q: Do you expect -- aside from the President's remarks, do you expect anything on paper coming out of this meeting -- results of the working groups, the results of the meetings between Gorbachev and Reagan?

MR. SPEAKES: Expect any paper? Right now I do not expect it. I was just giving you guidance that if there was anything, I don't think it would be that long.

Q: People coming back on the plane going to be prepared to talk about the results of the working groups?

MR. SPEAKES: Yes, they will be prepared to talk about the entire meeting because they were in the working groups. You do have a representative of both working groups on the press plane.

Q: Can you tell me why the Ridgway working group is called a humanitarian working group rather than human rights?

MR. SPEAKES: We see the terms as interchangeable.

Q The President in a speech recently made a distinction between human rights and humanitarianism.

MR. SPEAKES: Well, we, from our viewpoint, it's all interchangeable.

Andrew?

Q Do the Russians consider it interchangeable?

MR. SPEAKES: No, I don't think they do.

Q When the delegation returned from Geneva last November, there were extensive briefings at the White House that morning and afternoon, as you recall, to give some of the flavor and inside information on what went on in the meetings. Are similar briefings planned at the White House tomorrow?

MR. SPEAKES: Not tomorrow. But there will be a group in on Tuesday, as we customarily have. However, I don't think any appetite will go unassociated today.

Q Yes, but what about Tuesday, Larry?

MR. SPEAKES: Pardon?

Q What about Tuesday?

Q Will the President come in the Family Theatre with columnists on Tuesday?

MR. SPEAKES: Yes. The President is meeting with the columnists and --

Q Can you make a transcript of that available to those of us who have been covering this thing?

MR. SPEAKES: This is Pat's show. I'll ask him if we can do that. But as I say, you should have ample opportunity here before you leave to hear in great detail what's happened here.

Q Does human rights cover anything that humanitarianism does not cover or vice versa?

MR. SPEAKES: In our view, no. Wait a minute. Vice versa, in our view, no. Humanitarianism covers all subjects. Human rights --

Q They are synonymous and are interchangeable and one does not cover anything else --

MR. SPEAKES: You're really talking diplomatic niceties here.

Q Well, I mean since the President cut the difference in the U.N. speech --

MR. SPEAKES: The President's view is that if you want to call it humanitarianism, we see it as all encompassing. If you want to call it human rights, maybe humanitarianism is somewhat a derivative of that, if you want to do that -- a subdivision or an additional division of it. Check?

Q Larry?

MR. SPEAKES: Frank.

Q First of all, the world's most important network plan to carry Gorbachev's news conference live.

MR. SPEAKES: Live. TV in here?

Q Right, there.
... MR. SPEAKES: Sorry.

Q Secondly, can you say how the President felt this morning before he went off to his last meeting with Gorbachev? Any feel for that at all?

Q Did he have a hangover or anything?

Q This is the time to roll out "magnificent," Larry.

MR. SPEAKES: He may have been the only one here that didn't have a hangover. (Laughter.)

Q Was he impassive and relaxed? (Laughter.)

MR. SPEAKES: Wooden and relaxed?

Q Did you see him?

MR. SPEAKES: I saw him, face-to-face.

Q Was he magnificent?

Q Can you characterize in any way, Larry --

Q Was he stiff and impassive?

MR. SPEAKES: No, no. He was relaxed and animated. Is that right? Can you do that?

Q Are you planning any photo releases today of --

Q Excuse me --

MR. SPEAKES: I don't -- photo releases, and then I'll come back to Frank. No, I don't think so, Chris. We didn't see much that we got. I think the handshake will be it.

Frank.

Q No, that was a serious question: Is there any characterization you can give to the way the President feels these meetings have gone and how he felt as he headed out this morning?

MR. SPEAKES: I don't want to give a characterization of the President's view of the meetings. I think it will be better addressed at the end.

Where are we? Yes, Nick.

Q In the agreement with Congress to remove most of the prohibitions, was it also agreed to remove the "Buy American" prohibition on SDI that was in the Senate bill?

MR. SPEAKES: Yes, it was. And that was one of our things that we insisted on.

Q Mike.

Q Larry, could you give us a rundown of the officials who are fanning out from here other than Shultz to brief the allies?

MR. SPEAKES: Oh, no, I don't have that. The only thing

I have in whole. I don't have the others yet. We can try to get that.

Q Could you tell us if the report is true that you filed a formal protest with the Soviets over Arbatov's remarks yesterday?

... Q Question?

MR. SPEAKES: I wouldn't call it -- did I file a formal protest with the Soviets? I wouldn't call it a formal protest, but I certainly did make my views known in writing to Gerasimov.

Q About what?

... Q About what?

MR. SPEAKES: About the --

Q Could you tell us what you said in general?

MR. SPEAKES: No, I don't want to really go any further than that, but I will confirm that I did so, and indicated that we felt that it violated the spirit, if not the letter -- I guess that's sufficient -- of our agreement.

Q Arbatov?

MR. SPEAKES: Yes.

Q Larry --

Q Well, was your remark of Joidexter reflective of the President's view, Reagan's view, or your own view, or all three?

MR. SPEAKES: My own view.

Q Larry?

Q Was Gerasimov responded about Arbatov?

MR. SPEAKES: No, he has not. Here, we've just been handed -- Rowny and Adelman will go the Asian nations. I don't have a breakdown.

Q Larry?

MR. SPEAKES: Yes?

Q Was there any plan -- this morning, the foreign ministers were sitting in?

MR. SPEAKES: Yes.

Q Was there any plan for the two leaders to be alone at the end of the --

MR. SPEAKES: No.

Q No?

MR. SPEAKES: Not except in the walk-out.

Q How long is the TV speech going to be?

MR. SPEAKES: .. hasn't been written, OAK. ... I don't know no more than 20, although what we looked at absent the insert about what happened here, is longer than we wanted, so we chopped it back.

Q What about this afternoon? How long is his speech

MORE

1101-10/11

this afternoon?

MR. SPEAKER: Do we have a feel for that -- how long this afternoon is?

MR. ROUSSEL: Not really; we haven't seen it in --
Q... Larry --

MR. SPEAKER: We haven't seen it.

MR. ROUSSEL: Hasn't been finalized.

MR. SPEAKER: I would judge not more than five or ten minutes.

Q Twenty minutes is the speech tomorrow night, you're talking about?

MR. SPEAKER: That's our goal.

Q Okay.

MR. SPEAKER: But a goal is a goal.

Yes.

Q Two questions. One, before this meeting began, you were saying that you expected the leaders to spend a lot of time one-on-one. It appears that they've spent relatively little time one-on-one, and most of the time with foreign ministers. Why is that? And number two, can you elaborate on why you characterized their greetings as warm? Are they on a first name basis, or is there some other reason for you to say that they had these warm greetings?

MR. SPEAKER: On your first question, the characterization of the meeting as one-on-one -- essentially, it is a reduced version of the meetings that took place. There have been no extended sessions. So essentially, that is -- why do I characterize them as warm? Because the two shook hands and were smiling, and once again discussed the weather. The weather is always a good sign.

Okay, who have I left out? Right here.

Q Green Peace is saying that the United States and the Soviet Union more or less collaborated to keep their ship from entering the Reykjavik harbor even though the Icelandic authorities didn't mind. Is that true?

MR. SPEAKER: Never heard of it.

Okay. Oh, here we go. Shellin'?

Q Larry, would the U.S. government consider it espionage if a Soviet reporter helped the KGB make contact with a U.S. citizen?

MR. SPEAKER: That sounds like a Kinsolving question, simply because there has got to be a point two to it? (Laughter.)

Q Well, I'm trying to analogize from the reporting today about the contact that Daniloff helped the CIA make. I'm trying to see whether we would consider that espionage if done here.

MR. SPEAKER: I can't make any comparisons.

Final announcement here, today is what? Chris Wallace's birthday. Let's hear it for Chris. (Applause.)

Okay, who wants to lead Happy Birthday?

MORE...

APRIL 12/12

9 Nobody.

MR. SPEAKS: Andrea will lead it.

MR. SPEAKS: Thank you.

11:24 A.M. (b)

01/01/1971